Solution: Sum of Elements

Problem Statement

Given an array, find the sum of all numbers between the K1'th and K2'th smallest elements of that array.

Example 1:

```
Input: [1, 3, 12, 5, 15, 11], and K1=3, K2=6
Output: 23
Explanation: The 3rd smallest number is 5 and 6th smallest number 15. The sum of
numbers coming
between 5 and 15 is 23 (11+12).
```

Example 2:

```
Input: [3, 5, 8, 7], and K1=1, K2=4
Output: 12
Explanation: The sum of the numbers between the 1st smallest number (3) and the 4th
smallest
number (8) is 12 (5+7).
```

Solution

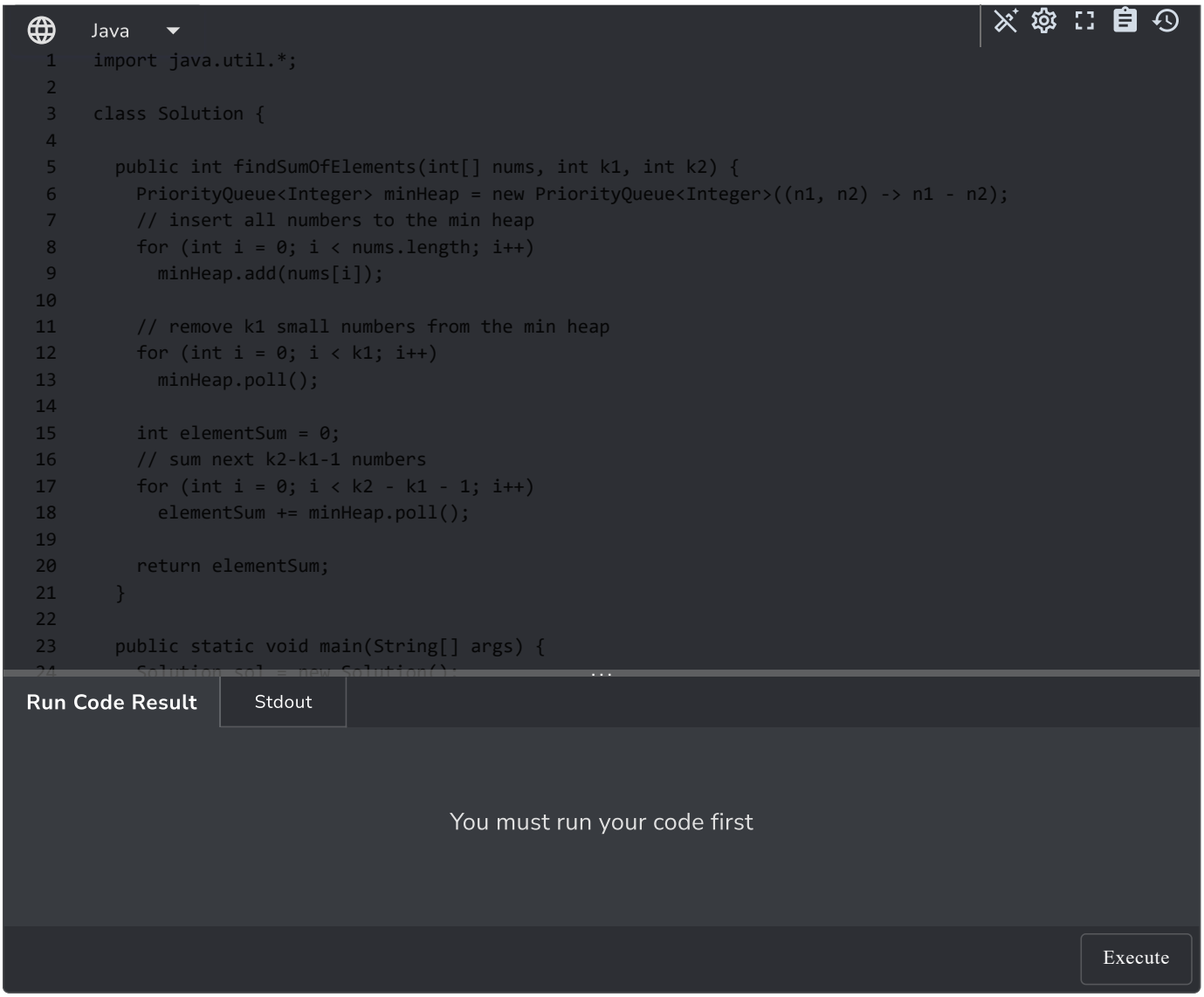
This problem follows the `Top 'K' Numbers pattern`, and shares similarities with `Kth Smallest Number`.

We can find the sum of all numbers coming between the K1'th and K2'th smallest numbers in the following steps:

1. First, insert all numbers in a min-heap.
2. Remove the first `K1` smallest numbers from the min-heap.
3. Now take the next `K2-K1-1` numbers out of the heap and add them. This sum will be our required output.

Code

Here is what our algorithm will look like:



Time Complexity

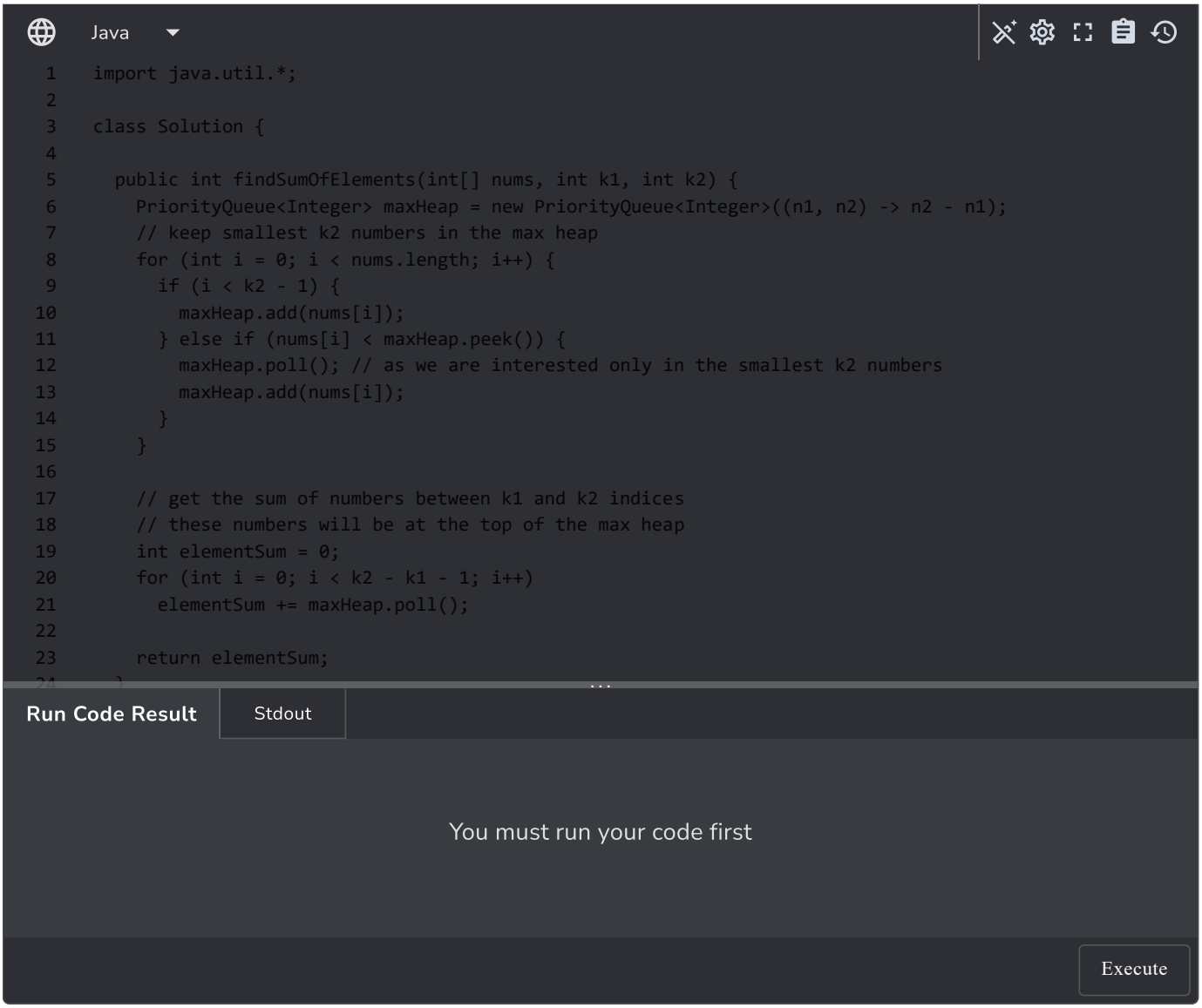
Since we need to put all the numbers in a min-heap, the time complexity of the above algorithm will be O(N*logN) where 'N' is the total input numbers.

Space Complexity

The space complexity will be O(N), as we need to store all the 'N' numbers in the heap.

Alternate Solution

We can iterate the array and use a max-heap to keep track of the top K2 numbers. We can, then, add the top `K2-K1-1` numbers in the max-heap to find the sum of all numbers coming between the K1'th and K2'th smallest numbers. Here is what the algorithm will look like:



Time Complexity

Since we need to put only the top K2 numbers in the max-heap at any time, the time complexity of the above algorithm will be $O(N * logK2)$.

Space Complexity

The space complexity will be O(K2), as we need to store the smallest 'K2' numbers in the heap.

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Sum Of Elements (Medium)

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Rearrange String (Hard)

Mark as Completed